

# CELL PHONES

Right now, as much as 18 per cent of the population owns at least one phone. The emphasis is on multimedia phones rather than budget phones; the first generation of cell phone adopters wants that extra.

With leading manufacturers like Nokia, Sony Ericsson, Motorola, and Samsung introducing a lot of models in the “multimedia device” category, the time to be stuck with “just a phone” seems to have come to an end.

Powerful cameras, lots of Flash storage, great PMP abilities, and inbuilt Wi-Fi and GPS make for some truly amazing convergence. Allied technologies have improved as well, like the displays—nothing short of astounding.

## MULTIMEDIA PHONES BETWEEN RS 14,001 AND RS 20,000

### The Reigning Champions Nokia 6300; Samsung SGH-E840

Both our champions have seen major price drops since we tested them. The Nokia 6300 makes a very sensible buy for the price (Rs 8,400, street price). The SGH-E840 (Rs 9,600) has a beautiful screen, and is one gorgeous phone—a beautiful slider mechanism, the slickest we’ve seen. If you happen to have a copy of our August 2007 issue, you’ll see the price difference between then and now...



Nokia 6300



Samsung SGH-E840

### The Contenders Sony Ericsson K790i; Nokia N73

A lot has changed since August 2007 when we conducted our shootout and adjudicated in joint favour of the Nokia 6300 and Samsung SGH-E840. For one, the Gold winner in our Up to Rs 20,000 multimedia category has seen a serious price drop. The excellent K790i has fallen to Rs 12,800 from Rs 16,222. An excellent screen, amazing music quality, and a brilliant 3.2 MP camera make the K790i

an absolutely superb buy. The Nokia N73 is another worthy candidate, priced at Rs 12,750: it has a superb screen (240 x 320, 2.4 inches), great camera on par with the K790i, and all the flexibility that Symbian S60 provides. The N73ME won Gold as well; although we didn’t test the non-music edition, the features remain the same apart from the dedicated music button.

### The Award Sony Ericsson K790i; Nokia N73

We find our two new contenders battling so hard for the crown that in the end, we’ve decided to award a joint Zero1 award to Sony Ericsson’s K790i and Nokia’s N73. Both offer tremendous value for money now after serious price



Nokia N73



Sony Erricson K790i

## MULTIMEDIA PHONES ABOVE RS 20,000

### The Reigning Champion Nokia N73 Music Edition

The Nokia N73 Music Edition was one fabulous 20,000-rupee-plus phone—till it became cheaper! It’s even better value for money now, but there are



higher-end multimedia phones available that have fallen into the price void it’s created.

### The Contenders Nokia N95; Nokia N95 8 GB; Sony Ericsson K850i

After a serious price drop, the N95 (street price Rs 24,550) is still around and going strong. The only issue we had with this device was poor battery life. The N95 8GB remedies this with a new 1200 mAh battery, a bigger screen (2.8-inch vs. 2.6-inch). In fact, the only reason the N95 lost out was due to its astronomical pricing at the time of our comparison test (Rs 40,249). It’s even got GPS and Wi-Fi—total connectivity. The new Sony Ericsson K850i is another beauty—a very feature-rich phone with a great camera.



Sony Ericsson K850i

### The Award Nokia N95

Nokia’s N95 emerges the Zero1 winner. It was overshadowed by its cheaper-by-half sibling—the N73ME—simply because of the price and the latter’s stellar battery life. With great signal quality, a 3.5mm jack, and GPS and Wi-Fi, the N95 is a fully-loaded pocket computer, which is exactly the way Nokia advertises it. If you’ve got Rs 25,000 to blow on a multimedia phone, it’d be a shame if you spent your money anywhere else.



## BUSINESS PHONES

### The Reigning Champion Nokia E50; Nokia E90 Communicator; Sony Ericsson P990i

Nokia’s E50, E90 Communicator, and the Sony Ericsson P990i were our Gold winners—three very deserving candidates in three very different price brackets. The Nokia E50 is compact, Symbian based (read feature-rich), and offers an affordable entry point to the Business series. The SE P990i offers a touchscreen, QWERTY and number keypad, Wi-Fi, and a good 2.0 megapixel camera, apart from docu-



Sony Ericsson P990i

Nokia E50

ment creation and editing software. Very feature-rich, the only minus being that it’s heavy. And when we think of the businessperson, we think Communicator.

### The Contender Nokia E51

Nokia’s E51 upsets the happy position of the E50. It’s got everything—a 16 million colour display, good battery life, a strong metal body, sleek lines, Wi-Fi, and best of all, a great keypad. We haven’t really seen anything more from other vendors, and certainly nothing threatening in the way of a high-end PDA.



### The Award

Nokia’s E90 Communicator—our Zero1 winner for this, the Business Phones category—retains its hold on the lofty high-end PDA market. With an excellent QWERTY and regular keypad and a host of features, it is still the most-sought-after businessperson’s companion in the high-end PDA category. At Rs 34,500, the E90 is one desirable phone!



Nokia’s E51 becomes the new entry-level business phone of choice. All the

features of its predecessor and a bagful more—a better screen, keypad, and much better build. Highly recommend for the price (Rs 12,000 approximate street price).